

Matthew Mettler

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science

University of Illinois

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<https://matthewmettler.github.io>

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Political Science, University of Illinois

Expected 2027

Dissertation: Fact-Opinion Differentiation Among Citizens: The Role of Partisan Identity, Cognitive Resources, and Media. Committee: Jeffery Mondak (Chair), Damarys Canache, Brian Gaines, and Thomas Rudolph

M.A. International Relations, University of South Dakota

2019

B.S. Political Science, South Dakota State University

2013

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political Behavior:

Democratic citizen competence, misinformation, partisan polarization, religious voters candidate evaluations, Citizen perceptions of public policy, and democratic accountability.

Political Methodology:

Measurement, causal inference, survey and experimental methods, and statistical modeling.

PUBLICATIONS

Books

Hibbing, **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J., & Raynal, I. (forthcoming). *(Mis)understanding the other side: How Americans explain opposing views*. Temple University Press.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J., & Peffley, M. (2026). Experiential Spillover in Public Views of Police and Courts. *Journal of Law and Courts*. [View online](#).

Canache, D., Knoll, N., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Indigenous quotas and symbolic representation in Latin America. *Journal of Politics in Latin America*. [View online](#).

McClinton, K., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Conceptualizing and measuring structural overlap in the political attitudes and orientations of multidimensional groups. *Social Science Quarterly*, 106(3). [View online](#).

Pagán-Márquez, A., Djupe, P., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2024). Was there an enthusiasm gap? Examining support for Donald Trump among evangelicals and nonevangelicals. *Politics & Religion*, 17(3), 410–430. [View online](#).

Mettler, M., & Mondak, J. (2024). Fact–opinion differentiation. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*, 5(2). [View online](#).

Working papers

Mettler, M., Accuracy, Bias, or Noise in Political Judgments? A Compositional Approach to Fact-Opinion Classification. (Job talk manuscript).

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J., Elite cues and Americans’ support for authoritarian world leaders. (Revise & Resubmit at *Democratization*).

Canache, D., **Matthew Mettler** & Mondak, J., Three Tests of the Political Impact of Individual Level Variation in the Negativity Bias. (Manuscript under review).

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. & Strojny, L., There but for Misfortune: The Impact of Economic Information and Misinformation on Voting in the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election. (Manuscript Under review)

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J., A Targeted Strategy for Improving the Mass Public’s Capacity to Identify True and False Political Claims. (Manuscript under review).

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.**, Moral tradeoffs for candidate choices: When do Evangelical voters excuse misconduct.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J., A multidimensional approach to measuring misinformation response tendencies.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J., Creating measures of retrospective perceptions beyond economic indicators.

Mettler, M. A Cognitive reminder: Nudging respondents to implement a more accurate criteria on political decision tasks.

Other publications

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Eviction expectations in the aftermath of the pandemic moratoria. *University of Illinois College of Law Legal Studies Research Paper* (No. 24-06).

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Texas' movement to online court is sensible, but more study should follow. *Voice for the Defense*, 20–22.

Gaines, B., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Fretwell-Wilson, R. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs – Policy Spotlight*.

Gaines, B., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Fretwell-Wilson, R. (2022). Courts and the housing market. *News-Gazette*.

Gaines, B., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, Fretwell-Wilson, R., & Miller, A. (2022). The impact of COVID-19 on state court proceedings: Five key findings. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs – Policy Spotlight*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Political Impact of Individual Level Variation in the Negativity Bias. 2026. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Newcastle. With Damarys Canache and Jeffery Mondak.

Economic Realities, Partisan Fictions: Facts, Perceptions, and Partisan Bias in Economic Voting. 2026. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago. With Jane Betchley, Alesha Lewis, and Jeffery Mondak.

Experiential Spillover in Public Views of Police and Courts. 2025. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Vancouver, CA. With Emma Henderson, Jeffery Mondak, and Mark Peffley.

Elite Cues Can Induce the Erosion of Democratic Support: Evidence from Two U.S. Surveys. 2025. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Prague. With Damarys Canache and Jeffery Mondak.

Fostering Political Lie Detection. 2025. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago. With Jane Betchley, Alesha Lewis, and Jeffery Mondak.

Measuring and Modeling Misinformation: A Strategy for Assessing the Relative Prevalence of Partisan and Residual Error. 2025. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago. With Jane Betchley, Alesha Lewis, and Jeffery Mondak.

When to Tolerate Immorality of Elected Officials and When Not To. 2025. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago. With Yeowon Lim.

Elite Cues and Americans' Support for Authoritarian World Leaders. 2025. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Southern Political Science Association, San Juan. With Damarys Canache and Jeffery Mondak.

Indigenous Quotas and Perceived Representation in Latin America. 2024. Presented at the Annual Meeting of the European Political Science Association, Cologne, Germany. With Nathan Knoll, Damarys Canache, and Jeffery Mondak.

Race and eviction during the pandemic. 2022. Presented at the Race and Social Justice Symposium, University of Illinois. with Brian Gaines, Jason Mazzone, & Robin Fretwell-Wilson

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of record

The U.S. Supreme Court	Summer 2026
Politics and the Media	Fall 2025
Introduction to American Politics	Spring 2025
Introduction to Politics	Fall 2024

Teaching assistant

Introduction to International Relations	Spring 2026
Strategic International Relations	Spring 2024
Junior Honors Thesis	Fall 2023
Introduction to Political Behavior	Fall 2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Institute of Government and Public Affairs	2021-2022
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- Conducted research as part of a team of scholars working to identify the effects of Covid-19 on state legal systems.
 - Prepared policy reports for publication as part of the Access to Justice initiative through IGPA.
 - Conducted in-depth interviews of Court officials for policy reports.
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AWARDS

University of Illinois list of Excellent Instructors	2026
University of Illinois list of Excellent Instructors	2025

FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

Dissertation Completion Fellowship (\$12,000) - University of Illinois	2026
Summer Dissertation Fellowship (\$3,000) - University of Illinois, Department of Political Science	2025
MPSA Travel Grant, University of Illinois, Department of Political Science	2026
MPSA Travel Grant, University of Illinois, Department of Political Science	2025

SERVICE & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Reviewer

Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review	2026
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Instructor

Political Science Math Camp–Probability & R programming	2025
Political Science Math Camp–Probability & R programming	2024
Political Science Math Camp–Linear Regression & R programming	2023

Committee

Faculty Search Committee-Graduate Representative	2024
Political Science Math Camp Committee	2023

Undergrad Senior Thesis advisor

Josh Ellison (Challenging the Partisan Voter: A Two-Dimensional Model of Vote Choice Beyond Ideology)	2026
Nathan Knoll (Effects of Legislative Gender Quotas on Political Efficacy)	2025
Vindhya Kalipi (I'm Just A Bill: The Impact of Civi Education on Democratic Engagement)	2024

Public Engagement

The 21st Show (Illinois Public Media radio)	2024
Interviews with WTAX (Illinois statewide radio)	2023
WCIA (Champaign, Illinois TV)	2023
CBS Chicago Morning Show	2023

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association (APSA)
International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP)
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)